

BRAVEHOOD

First Internal Playtest — Readiness Checklist & Estimates
Prepared 17 August 2026 · Target scope: Black Veil Sanatorium, Floor 1

Already in place (foundation)

- **Movement & camera:** shoulder-cam rig with look IK, turn-in-place, roll, jump, lock-on with dynamic feel.
- **Combat core:** hitboxes/hurtboxes, health, stamina, hit reactions, death handling, weapon movesets, procedural hits.
- **One enemy:** SimpleMobAI with the Plague Thrall prefab; Scavenger model available for a variant.
- **Equipment system:** bone-stitched armor swaps (helmet/torso/legs) plus weapon attach.
- **UI components:** HUD prefab with health/stamina bars, boss bar, lock-on reticle, item slot.
- **Audio:** audio manager, footsteps, character voice/action audio, stem-based adaptive music system.
- **Level:** Black Veil Floor 1 blockout with room culling and lighting/shadow-budget tooling.

The main gap is the **game loop itself** — nothing yet handles death → respawn, level objectives, pause/death screens, or pickups. That glue is the bulk of the remaining work.

Must-have for the first playtest

#	Task	What it involves	Estimate
1	Game loop glue	GameManager: player death → respawn at checkpoint, enemy reset, win condition (reach exit or clear target room).	1–2 days
2	Enemy combat pass	Tune SimpleMobAI (aggro, telegraphs, stagger windows), bake NavMesh in the blockout, add one second enemy variant (fast/weak Scavenger vs. the Thrall).	2–3 days
3	Encounter placement	Populate Floor 1: 6–10 encounters with a difficulty ramp, patrol points, player spawn.	1 day
4	Healing item	One flask-style consumable: pickup, input binding, wired into the existing ItemSlotUI.	1 day
5	UI glue	Pause menu (resume / restart / quit), death screen → respawn, minimal settings (sensitivity, volumes) using the GUI kit.	1 day
6	Combat & UI sound wiring	Swings, impacts, enemy hurt/death vocals, UI clicks from the Fantasy Sounds Bundle; MusicZones in the dungeon plus combat-state music via MusicDirector.	1–2 days
7	Level playability pass	Collider audit, doors, fall guards, lighting readability pass so testers don't get lost in the blockout.	1–2 days
8	Build & stability	Standalone build, framerate check with culling / shadow-budget systems on, fix whatever blocks.	1 day
9	Playtest kit	Short feedback form, debug overlay toggle, define the questions the test should answer.	0.5 day
	Total		9–13 days

Roughly 2–2.5 weeks of solo work at the must-have scope.

Worth it if time allows

- **Mini-boss (2–3 days)** — BossBarUI already exists; a bigger enemy with 2–3 attacks and a boss-room trigger gives the test a climax. Highest-impact optional item.
- **Second weapon moveset (1 day)** — WeaponMoveSet supports it; gives testers a comparison point.

Explicitly skip for this test

- More armor sets — the equipment system works; one set proves it.
- Inventory screen, minimap, loot/economy — not needed to answer “is the combat fun?”
- Art/polish pass on the blockout — fix readability only, not beauty.
- More music kits — one explore kit plus one combat layer is enough.

Suggested order

Week 1: items 1 → 2 → 3 — a playable loop exists by the end of the week.

Week 2: items 4–6 — feel and feedback.

Final days: items 7–9 — shippable to testers.

Compressing to ~1.5 weeks: cut the second enemy variant and the healing item, and run the test in-editor instead of a standalone build. Keep the death/respawn loop and the sound wiring — silent combat and manual scene restarts poison playtest feedback.